noun
Kegadian yg menimpa Rizal

Topic 5: Topic and Topic Sentences

Subject Verb
Rizal experienced a traffic accident.

1. Identifying the Topic of a Paragraph

1.1. What is a topic?

When you read for the meaning, you should begin by looking for the topic. This helps you connect what you read to what you already know. In order to find the topic, ask yourself:

"What is this about? What is the general idea?"

Example a:

In the group of words below, one of the words is the topic for all the other words. Circle the topic.

Elephants Zebras African animals Lions Tigers

The topic is African animals. All of the other words are examples of this topic.

Example b:

In the group of words below, one of the words is the topic for all the other words. Circle the topic.

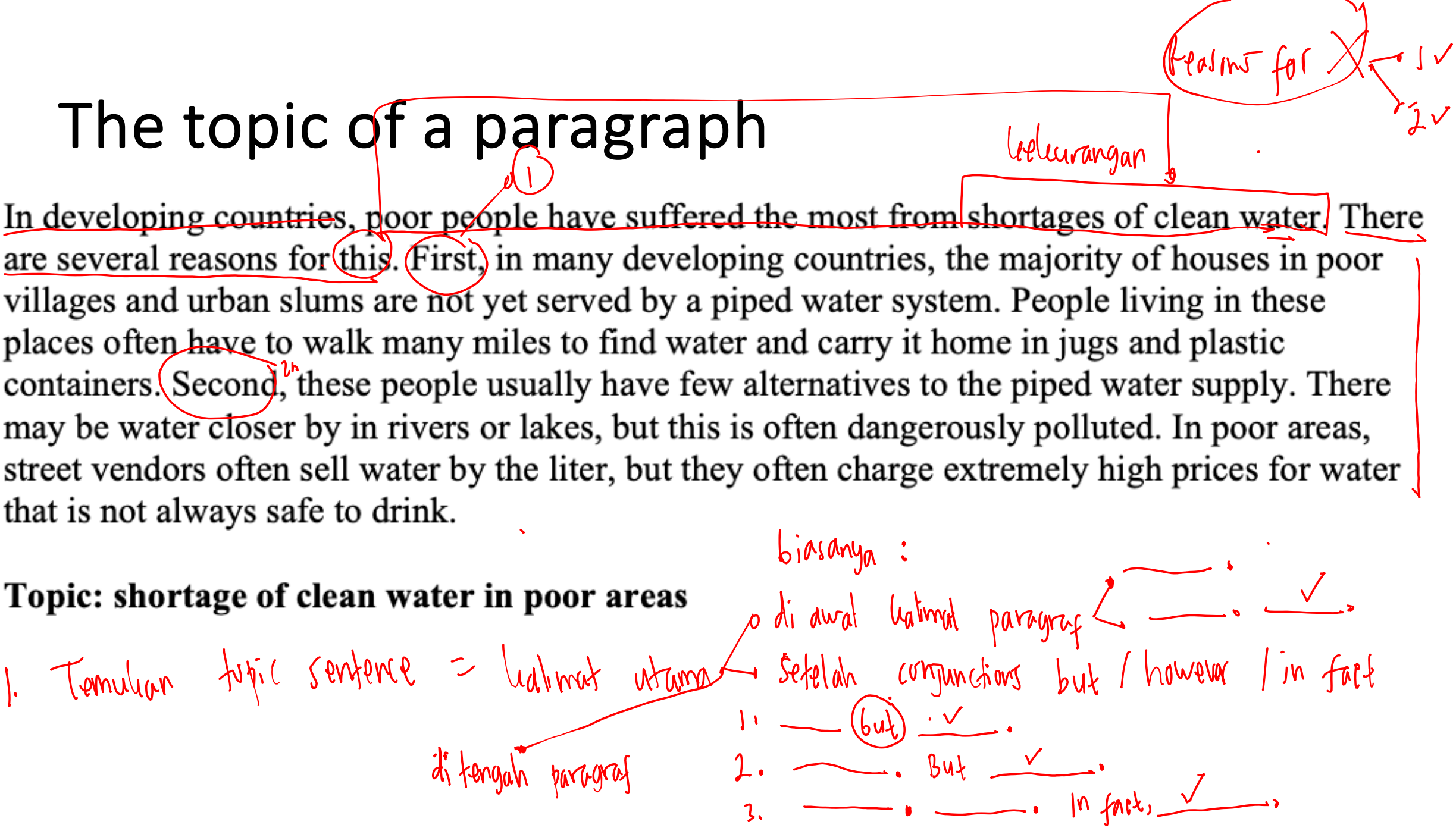
wheels tires brakes steering wheel seats doors car

The topic is car. All of the other words are parts of a car.

The topic of a paragraph

In developing countries, poor people have suffered the most from shortages of clean water. There are several reasons for this. First, in many developing countries, the majority of houses in poor villages and urban slums are not yet served by a piped water system. People living in these places often have to walk many miles to find water and carry it home in jugs and plastic containers. Second, these people usually have few alternatives to the piped water supply. There may be water closer by in rivers or lakes, but this is often dangerously polluted. In poor areas, street vendors often sell water by the liter, but they often charge extremely high prices for water that is not always safe to drink.

Topic: shortage of clean water in poor areas



The Construction of Houses

Topic sentence — terluat dari — Specific (1)

1. People usually build their houses out of the materials that are easily available to them. In some areas, most people build their homes out of wood. This is true in parts of North America and in Scandinavia. These areas have large forests, so wood is easy to get and inexpensive. (2) In many other areas of Europe, there are few forests left. Stone and brick are cheaper, so most people build their houses of these materials. (3) In tropical regions, houses are sometimes made from plants that grow there. For example, in parts of Africa or Asia, houses may be made out of bamboo. Finally, (4) in the very coldest areas near the Arctic, people make their homes out of blocks of ice.

a. Materials used for houses — apa

b. The wooden houses of Scandinavia — specific

c. Houses around the world — banget

topic → pilih yg general
- apa
- banget ✗
- jangan pilih yg specific

materials used for houses
1. some areas : wood
2. many other areas of Europe
3. .....
4. .....

houses

2. Houses in h o tcountries have many features t h a tare different from houses in cold countries. Houses in hot countries usually have thick walls and small windows to keep out the heat. In colder climates and darker regions, however, people do not have to worry about too much sun and heat. The houses therefore have larger windows to let in the sunlight. Another difference is that houses in hot climates usually have an out- door living area--a terrace, courtyard, or porch. In c o l d e rclimates, of course, people spend less time outdoors, so houses often do not have such areas.

perbedaan lainnya

a. The architecture of houses general banget

b. Houses in hot and cold countries general aja

c. Houses with small windows specific

1. Houses in hot countries .....
   In colder climates and darker regions..
2. Another difference

3. One of the most famous houses in the United States is Monticello. It was the home of Thomas Jefferson, the third President of the United States. Located on a hill near Charlottesville, Virginia, it has a beautiful view of the surrounding countryside. The house is famous, first of all, because it belonged to a President. It is also a fine example of early 19th century American architecture. Jefferson designed it himself in a style he had admired in Italy. Many American buildings of that time, in fact, imitated European styles. But while most were just imitations, his Monticello is lovely in itself. Furthermore, the design combines a graceful style with a typical American concern for comfort and function.

a. The view from Monticello

b. American architecture

c. Reasons for Monticello's fame

Mexico City: Water Shortages and a Sinking City

1. Like many other fast-growing cities around the world, Mexico City is facing severe water shortages. Many of its 20 million inhabitants receive only one hour of piped water per week. Others receive none at all for weeks on end. Those who can afford the expense build their own home water system to catch and keep rainwater to supplement the city water. The situation, according to international experts, is the result of a combination of factors. First, the system of pipes is old and poorly managed, with the result that the pipes lose almost 40 percent of the water that they distribute around the city. Second, the demand for water, which has grown with the rapid population growth, far exceeds the supply. Furthermore, the water is consumed not only by residents for household use, but also by thirsty industries such as beer-brewers and soft-drink bottlers, and there is little incentive[1] for them to conserve[2] or recycle water.

[1] *incentive:* something that encourages you to do something [2] *conserve:* to use less

Topic: (severe) water shortages in Mexico City

factors of

2nd 1st

2. The current water shortages in Mexico City contrast remarkably with the city's situation in the past. When the Spanish arrived at the Aztec capital in 1519, they found stone buildings and gardens set on an island in the middle of a vast series of interconnected lakes—an "enchanted vision," according to one Spanish soldier. The Spanish destroyed the buildings, and began draining[1] the water from the lakes to build what became Mexico City. For the next four centuries, the city was able to meet its water needs from springs, shallow wells, and the remaining lake water. In the mid-nineteenth century, the residents of the city began taking water from the underlying aquifer.[2] In the twentieth century, as water needs grew and supplies from the aquifer became inadequate, city authorities brought water up from two nearby river systems. Twenty-five years ago, they began piping in water from 80 miles (130 km) away. Because Mexico City is located on a highland, the water must all be pumped uphill at considerable expense.

1 *drain:* to make the water flow away

2 *aquifer:* a layer of stone or earth under the surface of the ground that contains water

Topic: the water situation in Mexico city in the past

the past water situation in Mexico city

3. Related to the shortages is another problem: the city is sinking. Other cities around the world (such as Venice, Italy) are also experiencing this phenomenon, but the situation is most dramatic in Mexico City. Some neighborhoods are going down by as much as 15 inches (40 cm) a year, or a total of about 30 feet (9.1 m) over the last century. The cause is simply the fact that water is being removed from the aquifers faster than it can be replaced by rainwater. As water is removed, the spongy soil dries up and becomes more compact,[1] and the city slowly settles down. The effects are evident. At the Monument to Independence, which was built at ground level in 1910, twenty-three more steps were recently added to reach the base from the current ground level. Buildings and streets have been damaged by the uneven settling of the city, and so have the water and sewage systems. Since the city is now 6 feet below the level of nearby Lake Texcoco, flooding has become a frequent problem and because of the poor state of the sewage system, the flood waters are often full of untreated waste.

[1]*compact:* packed or put together firmly

Topic: ① the sinking city of Mexico.
② the cause and effect of the sinking city of Mexico

Topic sentences

Effects of Weather and Climate

1. Violent storms cause damage and deaths all over the world, but sometimes people make the consequences worse. For example, too many people living in dangerous areas can turn a storm into a disaster. In Bangladesh, the flat river valley often floods. In the past, there were few people in this area and they could escape to higher land. Now, millions of people live there and they cannot escape when there are floods. Sometimes, too, there is more damage than necessary because people do not build homes that are safe or strong enough. This was the case when a terrible storm hit southern Florida. Many people died or lost their homes because the wind blew away poorly-made buildings.

Topic: people who make the consequences of violent storms worse

Topic sentence: people make the consequences worse

① for example, ...

Supporting details ②

SD 1

SD 2

topic sentence

effects

topic sentence SD 2 SD 3 SD 1

2. When summer brings very hot weather, many people suffer more than they need to. There are a number of ways to make life more comfortable in the heat. First of all, you can try to keep your home as cool as possible. It is best to close all the windows and curtains during the hottest part of the day. Then, when it is cooler in the evening, you can open them up again. It is important also to keep yourself cool by wearing loose, light clothes. Cotton is the best material for clothes in hot weather. And finally, you should try to stay calm and relaxed. You could even try a nap after lunch, like many people who live in hot climates. This way you are more rested and ready to enjoy the cool evening hours.

Topic: a number of ways to make life more comfortable in the heat

Topic sentence:

Supporting details:

3. Scientists believe that the earth's climate may be warming up. This trend probably began thousands of years ago. Many areas of the earth used to be covered with ice that has now melted. However, in recent years, the warming trend has speeded up. Scientists think that part of the reason for this may be carbon dioxide pollution from industry and automobiles. The carbon dioxide mixes with other gases. This pollution covers the earth like a blanket and keeps it warmer. Another reason for the warming may be the fact that the earth is losing its forests. Forests are an important part of the earth's system for using up carbon dioxide and keeping the air temperature cool.

topic sentence

topic sentence

SD 1 : reason 1

SD 2 : reason 2

Topic: the warming trend / Reasons for the warming trend

Topic sentence:

Supporting details: